Debate Tournament Prep Syllabus

Nov 3, 2026 · @Nathan S.

Five 55-minute classes on Tuesdays and Thursdays get our team of three ready for the 2026 Simson Debate Tournament. Most topics are new, so every class spends most of its time **getting to know the arguments**, one or two motions at a time. Homework is two short tasks.

Our sides

Round	Motion	Our side
Round 1 (notes allowed)	THBT companies should become public companies when they want to grow.	**Government**
Rounds 2–3	Rent freezes · Humanoid robots · Excess profits · Equality vs. equity	**Opposition**
Final	Unknown: could be a new motion	Decided on the day

Schedule

Class	Date	Focus	In class	Homework
1	Thu Nov 5	Our team and the Round 1 motion	Learn the tournament and your role (PM, DPM or GW). Build an argument: Claim → Mechanism → Impact. Read the Going Public motion together and say our side in one sentence.	Read Going Public in Topics Made Easy. Fill the Government page of the Going Public card.

Class	Date	Focus	In class	Homework
2	Tue Nov 10	Our Round 1 case: Going Public	Split the case between PM, DPM and GW. Practise answering Opposition's 2 main arguments. Learn POIs. Plan your own speech in bullet points.	Finish your Round 1 outline. Read Rent freezes and Humanoid robots in Topics Made Easy.
3	Thu Nov 12	Opposition: Rent freezes, Humanoid robots	Learn one way to answer any argument: "They said… / But… / Even if…". For each motion: what Government will say, what we say, our "Even if".	Fill the Opposition page for Rent freezes and Humanoid robots. Read Excess profits and Equality vs. equity.
4	Tue Nov 17	Opposition: Excess profits, Equality vs. equity, the Whip	The same routine for two more motions. The Whip practises summing up a clash.	Fill the Opposition page for Excess profits and Equality vs. equity. Say your Round 1 speech aloud twice.
5	Thu Nov 19	Round 1 run-through and final prep	Give our Round 1 speeches with notes; the teacher gives the Opposition speeches. Quick review of the four Opposition motions. Plan a surprise motion together. Tournament-day rules.	Read your Round 1 outline and Opposition cards once. Sleep well.

Reminders: Speeches are 3 minutes. Only Round 1 allows notes. Fill only **our side's** page of each topic card; read the other side so you know what to answer.